

Morphology and word-formation

Lexicology and Lexicography – **Course Website**

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Outline

1. **Lexical innovation**: How do new words arise and what are the key types?
2. **Morphology vs word-formation**: What's the distinction and scope?
3. **Inflection in Present-Day English**: What inflectional morphemes exist?
4. **Morphological building blocks**: What are morphemes and their categories?
5. **Morphemic processes**: How do derivation and compounding work?
6. **Non-morphemic processes**: What are conversion, clipping, blending, back-formation, and acronyms?
7. **Practice**: How can we analyse word structure?

Introduction

Lexical innovation

How do new words arise?

Lexical innovation

How do new words arise?

Kerremans ([2015](#))

		meaning	
		old	new
form	old	x	<i>subprime</i>
	new	<i>snowicane</i>	<i>detweet</i>

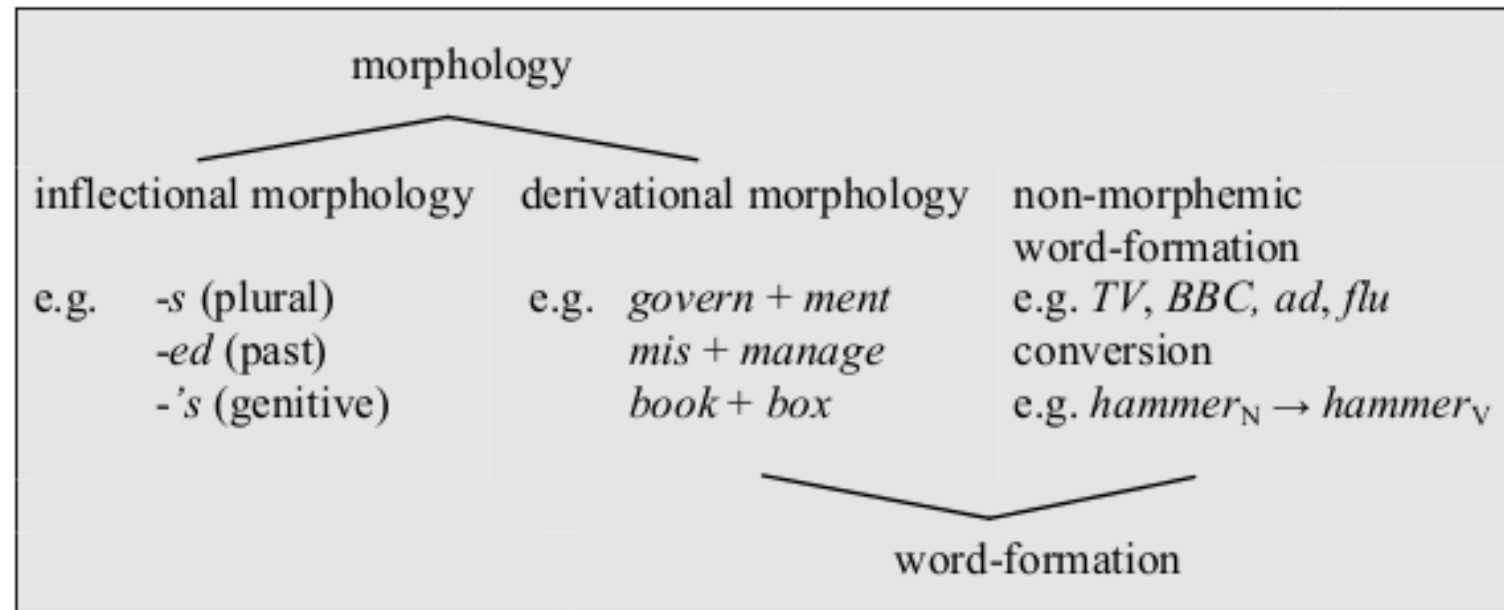
Morphology vs word-formation

What is the difference between morphology and word-formation?

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Schmid (2016)



Inflection in Present-Day English

Which inflectional morphemes exist in Present-Day English?

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Schmid (2016)

word class	morpheme	functions/meanings
noun	{plural}	marking of plural
verb	{genitive}	marking of genitive; possession, part-of etc.
	{3 rd person}	3 rd person singular present
	{ing}	present participle
	{ed ₁ }	simple past
adjective	{ed ₂ }	past participle
	{er}	comparative
	{est}	superlative
numerals	{th}	ordinal number

Morphemic word-formation processes

Morphological building blocks

Which types of morphemes are there and how do they differ?

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Schmid (2016)

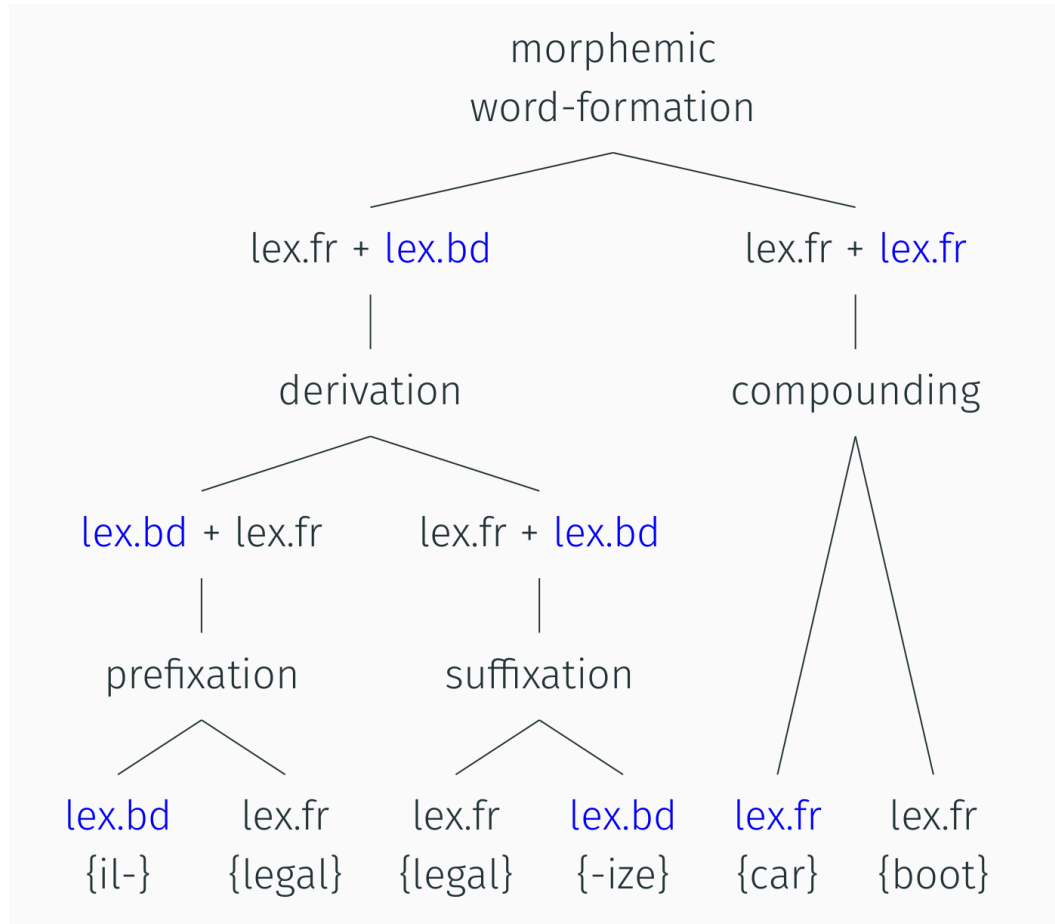
morpheme class	attributes	examples
lexically free (lexemes, roots)	• semantically autonomous • open class • inflecting (except for interjections)	N: {head}, {key}, {part} Adj: {green}, {pale}, {nice} Adv: {fast}, {well}, {here} V lex: {plan}, {teach}, {pass} Interj: {ouch}, {damn}
grammatically free (lexemes, function words)	• not autonomous, relational • closed class • not inflecting	V aux: {will}, {must}, {have} Pron: {she}, {which}, {why} Prep: {of}, {in}, {at} Conj: {and}, {that}, {as} Num: {one}, {thousand}
lexically bound (derivational affixes)	• (more or less) open class • create lexemes with discrete meaning • usually change word class (suffixes) • closer to the stem	prefixes: {re-}, {dis-}, {post-} suffixes: {-er}, {-ify}, {-ment}
grammatically bound (inflectional suffixes)	• closed class • create word-forms with unchanged meaning • always maintain word class • further away from the stem	for Ns: {plural}, {genitive} for Vs: {3 rd pers. pres. sg.}, {ing}, {ed ₁ }, {ed ₂ } for Adjs: {er}, {est} for Nums: {th}

Overview of morphemic word-formation processes

Which morphemic word-formation processes are there?

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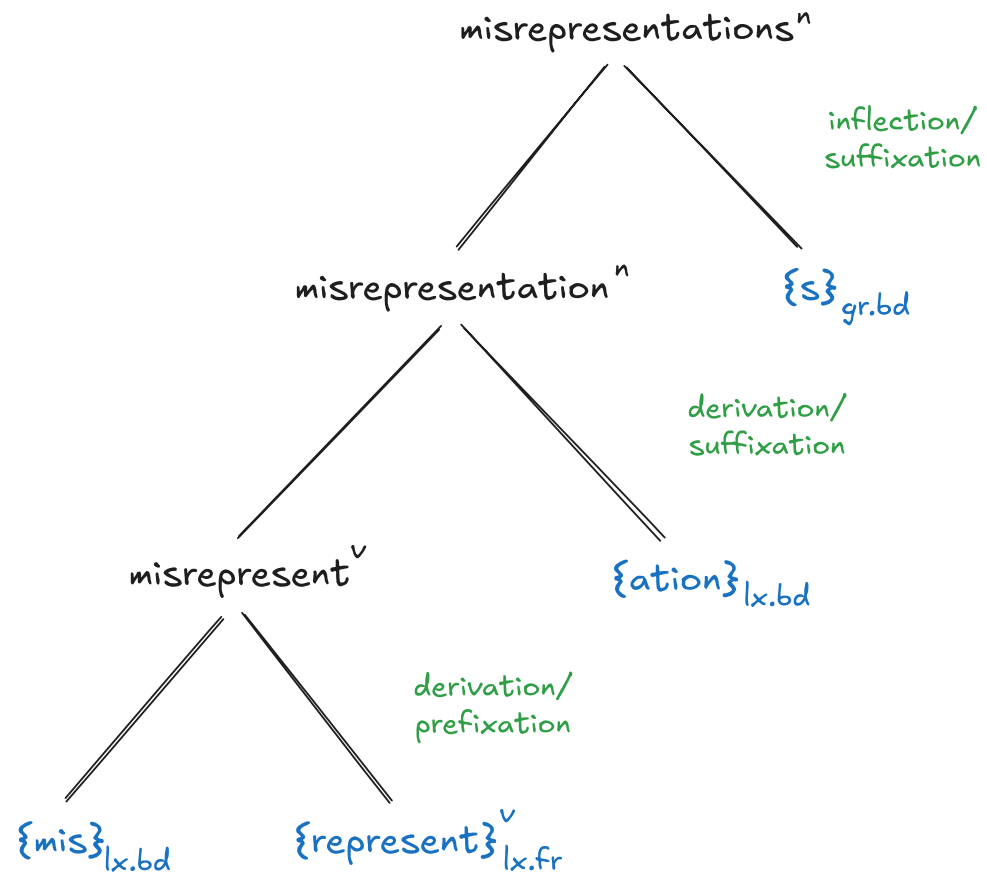


Exercise: conducting a morphological analysis

Provide a full morphological analysis for the word *misrepresentations*.

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Non-morphemic word- formation

Overview

Which non-morphemic word-formation processes are there?

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Process	Features	Examples
clipping	parts of words are deleted without a change in meaning	<i>bike, exam, fridge</i>
blending	forms and meanings of words are merged	<i>smog, brunch</i>
acronyms	shortened form retaining the initial letters of compounds or other fixed sequences of words; pronounced as <i>words</i>	<i>NATO, laser, AIDS</i>
initialisms/ alphabetisms	shortened form retaining the initial letters of compounds or other fixed sequences of words; pronounced as <i>sequences of letters</i>	<i>CNN, OED, USA</i>
back-formation	word-class-changing word-formation process which deletes a morpheme or morpheme-like element; longer form pre-existing	<i>babysit</i> / ^v < / <i>babysitter</i>
reduplication	rare word-formation process repeating a word or word-like element either identically or in a slightly varied form	<i>walkie-talkie, hip-hop</i>

Zero-derivation / conversion vs derivation

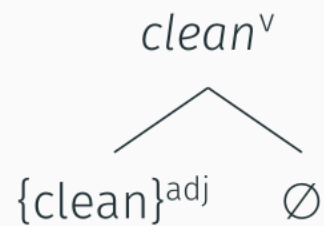
What is the difference between zero-derivation and conversion?

Zero-derivation / conversion vs derivation

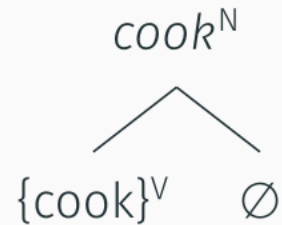
What is the difference between zero-derivation and conversion?

Definition: Creation of a new lexeme by changing the word class of an existing word without the addition of an overtly marked suffix.

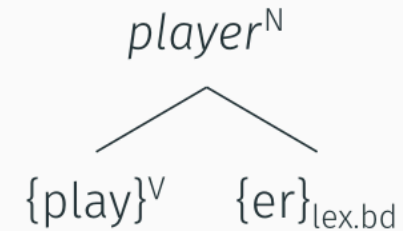
Zero-derivation: Adj > V



Zero-derivation: V > N



cf. derivation:



Compounding vs blending

Compound types

Type	Structure	Example	Paraphrase
endocentric	AB is a type of B	'apple pie'	'an apple pie is a type of pie'
exocentric	AB is neither A nor B, but C	'egg head'	'an egg head is not an egg nor a head, but a person'
copulative ¹	AB is both A and B	'singer-songwriter'	'a singer-songwriter is sb. who is both a singer and a songwriter'

Formal properties of blends

swooshtika – derogatory reference to Nike logo

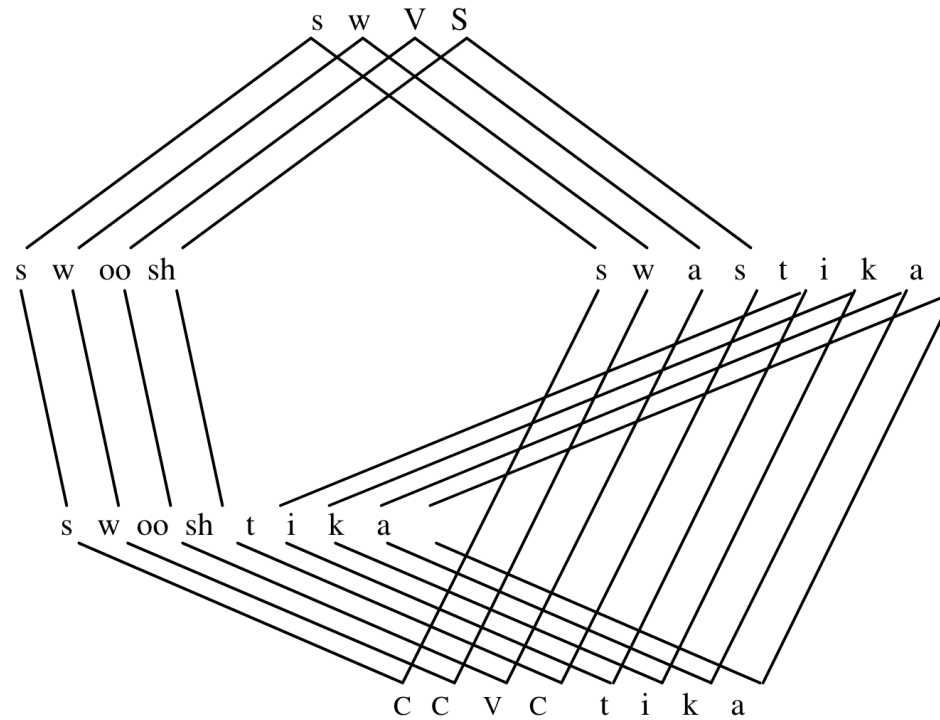


Figure 1. Phonological Relations in an English Blend

Kemmer (2003)

Semantic properties of blends

glitterati

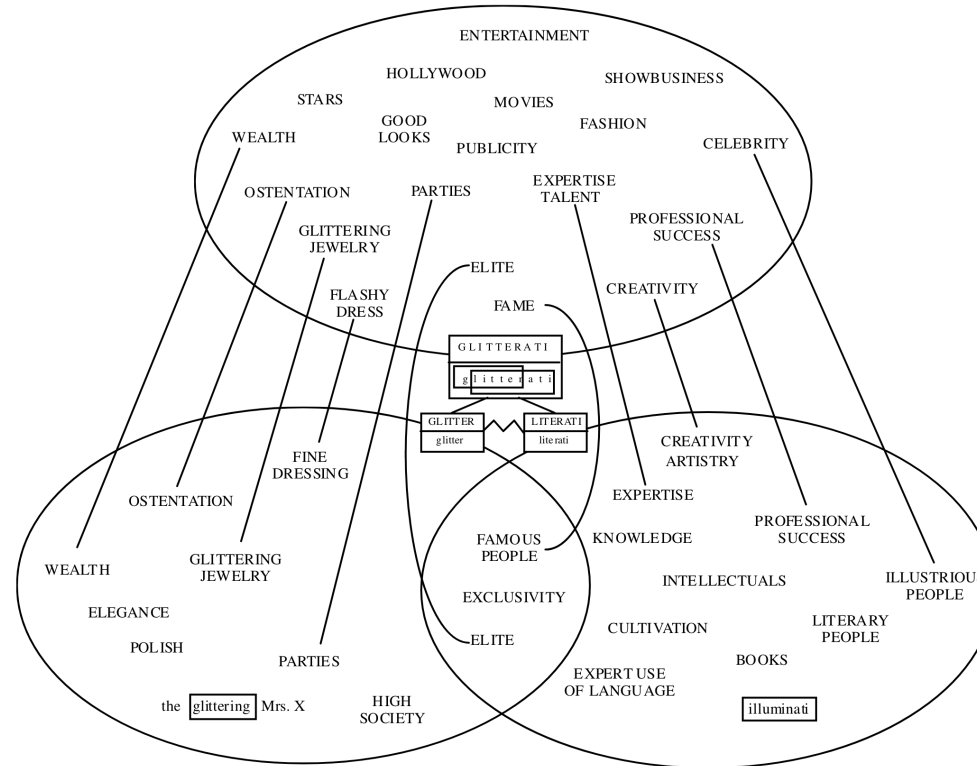


Figure 2. Cognitive Domains in the Blend glitterati

Kemmer (2003)

Quiz: classify word-formation
processes

Interactive version

Max challenge attempts exceeded. Please refresh the page to try again!

[Interactive version on Wayground.](#)

Reference answers

Word	Process/type
<i>friendship</i>	derivation
<i>distasteful</i>	derivation (prefix + suffix)
<i>washing machine</i>	compounding (endocentric)
<i>redneck</i>	compounding (exocentric)
<i>singer-songwriter</i>	compounding (copulative)
<i>paperback</i>	compounding (endocentric)
<i>cook</i> (N) ← <i>cook</i> (V)	conversion
<i>to Google</i> (V)	conversion
<i>fridge</i>	clipping
<i>Brangelina</i>	blending
<i>swooshtika</i>	blending
<i>sightsee</i>	back-formation
<i>LOL</i>	acronym/initialism

Morphemic vs non-morphemic WF – summary

	morphemic	non-morphemic	examples
building blocks	morphemes	parts of words	<i>br + unch</i>
combination	adding morphemes	removing parts	<i>in flu enza</i>
serialization	concatenative	interspersed	<i>CHuckLE x snORT</i>
regularity	clear rules, predictable patterns	heterogeneous, high variability	<i>Brangelina</i>
cognitive processing	largely unconscious	conscious coining	<i>BBC</i>

Further reading

- Bauer, Laurie. 2022. *An Introduction to English Lexicology*. Edinburgh University Press.
- Lipka, Leonhard. 2002. *English Lexicology: Lexical Structure, Word Semantics and Word-Formation*. Tübingen: Narr.
- Schmid, Hans-Jörg. 2016. *English Morphology and Word-Formation - an Introduction*. 2nd ed. Berlin: Erich Schmidt Verlag.

References

Kemmer, Suzanne. 2003. "Schemas and Lexical Blends." In *Motivation in Language: Studies in Honor of Günther Radden*, edited by Günther Radden and Hubert Cuyckens, 69–97. J. Benjamins Pub. Co.

Kerremans, Daphné. 2015. *A Web of New Words*. Bern: Peter Lang. <https://doi.org/10.3726/978-3-653-04788-2>.

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